



Evening to remember: Manu's mother, Sumedha Bhaker, flaunts her daughter's trophy on a night she dazzled as Sportstar of the Year — Female and Sportswoman of the Year — Olympic Sport (facing page, left). Manu also shared a candid moment with Indian chess grandmaster Vidit Gujrathi and his fiancée. PICS: EMMANUAL YOGINI

and possess great knowledge of focus, meditation, and yoga. These things help a lot."

For her own goals, Manu has decided to prioritise fitness in 2025 rather than focus on specific competitions. "This season, my primary goal is to be very fit. Then, I'll sit down with my coach to plan for the competitions we want to target. We also have the World Championships later this year."

This decision is influenced by a persistent elbow issue that has troubled her for some time.

Manu has made minor adjustments to her shooting equipment to aid in her rehabilitation. She explains, "There will be some changes to my gear now. We already made some modifications to the grips right after the Olympics.

Certain angles were putting too much strain on my arm. I've had multiple injuries, and even now, we are trying to find the best-suited equipment, grips, posture, and stance. The aim is to minimise injuries in the long run."

A journey towards peak fitness begins with an athlete's diet, and Manu is conscious of this aspect.

"I always try to eat home-cooked food. My mum almost always travels with me during training or competitions. Staying fit should be a principle in life. When your body is healthy, your focus improves, and you feel more confident. Strength also helps prevent injuries," she explains.

Despite a lavish spread at the awards ceremony, Manu quietly retreated to her room after the

QUICK BYTES

Dream holiday

I'd love to relive the days of sailing with my family — chatting in the anchor area, playing on the deck — just living carefree again

Tattoo at gunpoint

I already have something in mind. If something drastic happens, I'll get it done. Not revealing much for now!